

# Grammar Addendum — slash form + namespace prefix (operator mandate, 2026-06-09)

EXTENDS the §11.4.140 action-prefix design with two equivalences. Every registered action (e.g. BACKGROUND) MUST be invocable in ALL of these EQUIVALENT forms — same action, same expansion, same execution:

| # | Form                          | Example                     | Notes                                                                                                              |
|---|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | ACTION_NAME :: <rest>         | BACKGROUND :: Do X          | bare :: form (no namespace)                                                                                        |
| 2 | PREFIX::ACTION_NAME :: <rest> | DEFAULT::BACKGROUND :: Do X | namespaced :: form                                                                                                 |
| 3 | /ACTION_NAME <rest>           | /BACKGROUND Do X            | bare slash form — ONLY if /ACTION_NAME does NOT collide with an existing/ built-in slash command of the host agent |
| 4 | /PREFIX::ACTION_NAME <rest>   | /DEFAULT::BACKGROUND Do X   | namespaced slash form — disambiguates from any existing / ACTION_NAME; ALWAYS safe                                 |

## Namespace prefix

- PREFIX is an action NAMESPACE. The reserved default namespace is **DEFAULT**. Custom namespaces are permitted (e.g. a project/plugin namespace) so the same action can run under the default OR a custom prefix.

- An action is executable WITH or WITHOUT the prefix:  
`BACKGROUND :: ≡ DEFAULT::BACKGROUND :: ≡ /BACKGROUND ≡ /  
 DEFAULT::BACKGROUND.`
- Namespace separator inside the token is `::` (no surrounding spaces): `PREFIX::ACTION_NAME`. This is **DISTINCT** from the action-body separator `::` (spaces both sides) used in forms 1/2 between the token and `<rest>`.

## Grammar (extended, anchored to first non-blank line)

- `::`-form regex: `^(?:([A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*)::)?([A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*)::`  
`(.*)$` → group1=optional PREFIX, group2=ACTION\_NAME,  
group3=rest.
- slash-form regex: `^/(?:([A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*)::)?([A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*)`  
`\s+(.*)$` → group1=optional PREFIX, group2=ACTION\_NAME,  
group3=rest.
- Token case: ACTION\_NAME and PREFIX are UPPERCASE `[A-Z][A-Z0-9_]*` (directive/macro convention — DISTINCT from the §11.4.29 lowercase file/dir naming, which still governs the registry FILE names + script names). DEFAULT is the reserved default-namespace literal.
- Escape: leading `\` makes the line literal (no expansion):  
`\BACKGROUND :: x` and `\BACKGROUND x`.
- Unknown grammar-shaped token (looks like an action but not in the registry) → ask per §11.4.66/§11.4.105, NEVER silently expand/drop (§11.4.6).

## Conflict rule (slash form)

- /ACTION\_NAME (form 3) is honored as the action ONLY when ACTION\_NAME (case-folded for the collision check) does not match a built-in/host slash command. The registry MAY carry a per-action slash\_bare: true|false|auto and a slash\_conflicts: [...] list; auto = enable bare slash unless a known host command collides.
- Form 4 (/PREFIX::ACTION\_NAME) is ALWAYS unambiguous and always honored.

## Registry schema additions

```
grammar:  
  default_namespace: DEFAULT  
  namespace_separator: '::'      # inside the token, no spaces  
  body_separator: ' :: '        # token <-> rest, spaces both  
                                sides ('::' form)  
  slash_prefix: '/'
```

```

    slash_body_separator: ' '          # token <-> rest (slash form)
actions:
  - name: BACKGROUND
    namespaces:
      [DEFAULT]          # which namespaces this action is
                        registered under
    slash_bare: auto      # bare /BACKGROUND honored
                        unless host-command collision
    slash_conflicts: []   # known colliding host slash
                        commands (forces /DEFAULT::BACKGROUND)
    # ... expansion, rules, composes_with as before

```

## Impl impact

- `apx_parse_prefix` MUST recognize all 4 forms, returning (namespace|DEFAULT, action, rest, matched\_form).
- `apx_expand_prompt` resolves namespace+action against the registry; bare-slash honored per the conflict rule.
- LAYER-2 hook handles all 4 first-line forms.
- The slash-command generator already emits `/background` (form 3) per agent; ADD the namespaced `/default::background` (form 4) where the agent's command syntax allows `::` (else a `default-background` alias) + document the collision fallback.
- `recognition_instruction.md` teaches the agent all 4 forms + the conflict rule + escape.

Naming: action/namespace tokens UPPERCASE; FILES/DIRS lowercase snake\_case (§11.4.29). DEFAULT is the reserved default namespace literal.